CUSHING PUBLIC SCHOOLS BOARD OF EDUCATION POLICY	*Business and Auxiliary Services* Adopted: August 9, 2021

SCHOOL VOLUNTEERS

The board encourages community members to volunteer at the district's schools to augment its programs. The board has adopted this policy to clarify requirements, expectations and responsibilities related to volunteering for the school district.

The district does not discriminate against volunteers on the basis of race, color, sex, pregnancy, gender, gender expression or identity, national origin, religion, disability, veteran status, sexual orientation, age, or genetic information. All individuals who volunteer for the district should be committed to the district's non-discrimination requirements and its goal of providing quality education and related programs to the children of the community.

The district has a myriad of needs which can be filled by volunteers, and any individual interested in being a school volunteer should contact the building principal to begin the volunteer approval process. Prior to volunteering, all volunteers are required to:

- submit an information form
- authorize a criminal records check
- pay the records check fee (fee may be waived in cases of demonstrated financial hardship)
- review relevant school policies
- sign the volunteer compliance agreement

No individual will be permitted to volunteer until all of the required paperwork has been submitted and the criminal records check has been reviewed and approved by the Superintendent. In the event the criminal records check reveals adverse information regarding the potential volunteer, the administration will review the facts and circumstances to determine whether an exception can be granted and in what capacity, if any, the individual may be permitted to volunteer. All potential volunteers will be given the opportunity to explain any adverse information which is discovered during the criminal records check prior to an application being denied.

In addition to the foregoing, there are also special considerations for volunteers who are driving on school field trips or who are volunteering in connection with athletic events. Individuals who transport students in personal vehicles are required to provide additional documentation and declarations related to their driving history and insurance. Individuals who volunteer in connection with athletic events are required to participate in sport-specific education programs.